

1450–1500

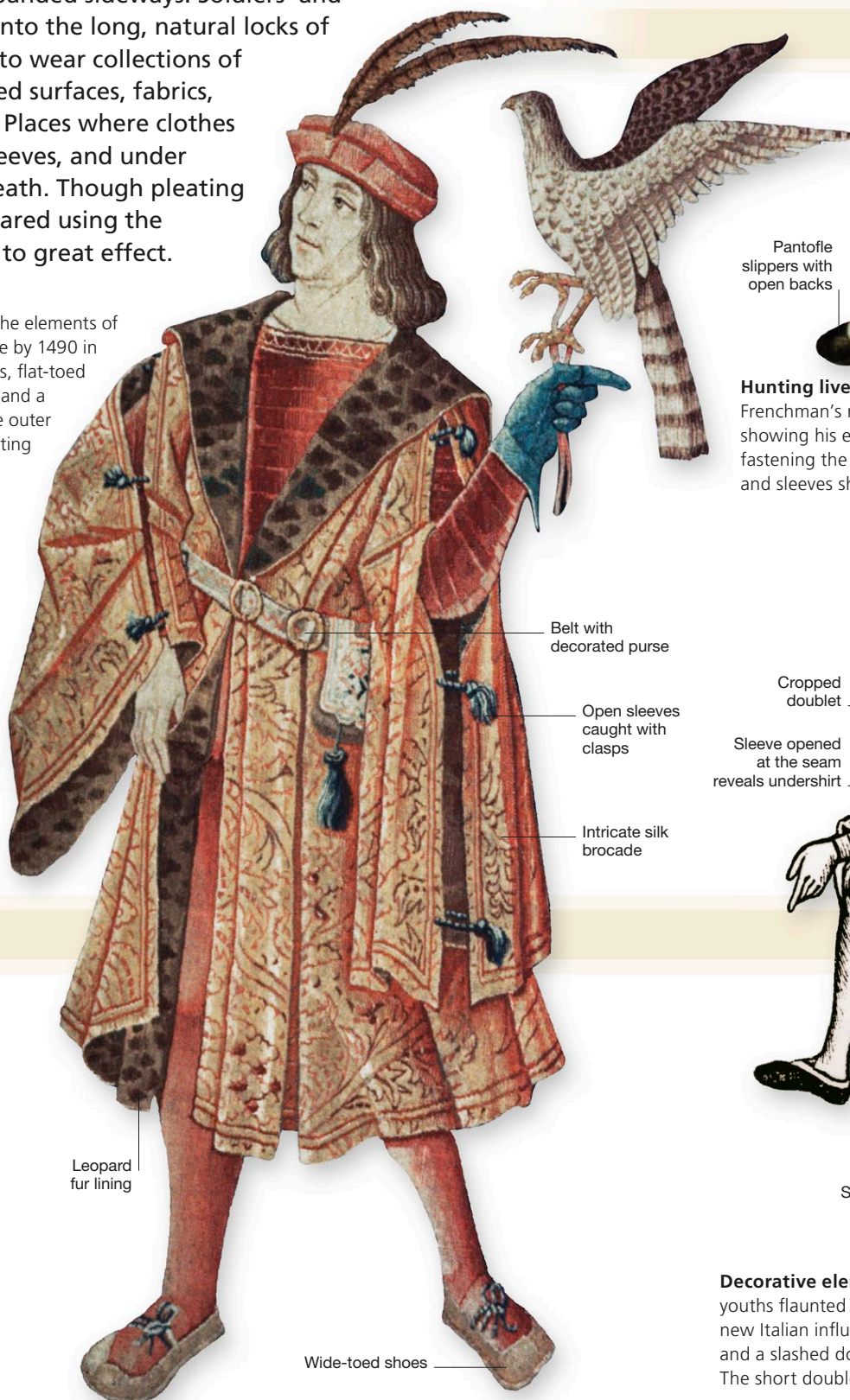
RENAISSANCE MEN

From the 1480s new broad shapes began to replace the last traces of the medieval in men's clothing. Instead of an emphasis on a long, vertical male figure, the Renaissance man, with his earthier, artistic, and scientific pursuits and a new interest in classical ideas, favoured blunt and square forms that expanded sideways. Soldiers' and statesmen's cropped hair grew into the long, natural locks of poets and scholars. Men began to wear collections of clothing as an ensemble and used surfaces, fabrics, and edges as decorative spaces. Places where clothes joined – in seams, the tops of sleeves, and under lacing – revealed layers underneath. Though pleating continued, natural folds reappeared using the elegant drape of circular pieces to great effect.

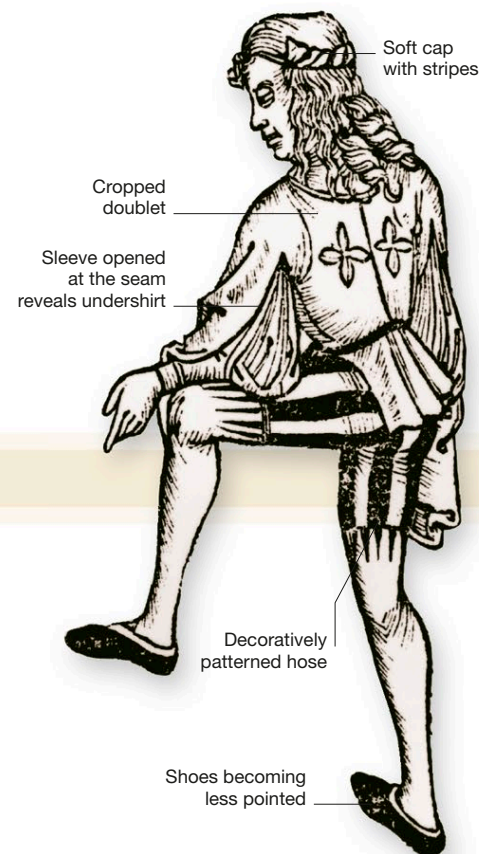
Wide and square All the elements of a new style were in place by 1490 in France – broad shoulders, flat-toed shoes, copious draping, and a wide neckline. The loose outer gown hides the close-fitting doublet and hose.



Short robe, long toes Serving the king at table was an honour for English lords. This man's sword shows his knightly position. The exaggerated long toes of *poulaine* shoes were very fashionable at court.



Hunting livery The two colours in this young Frenchman's robe were probably livery, showing his employment by a lord. The lacing fastening the front was now visible. The collar and sleeves showed a careful cut and fit.



Decorative elements Northern European youths flaunted fashion knowledge by blending new Italian influences such as long, curling hair and a slashed doublet sleeve with local styles. The short doublet was a sign of youth.